

Covenants

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Agreements between two parties.

Genesis 26:28 And they said, We saw certainly that the LORD was with thee: and we said, Let there be now an Oath Betwixt us, even Betwixt us and thee, and let us make a covenant with thee;

Daniel 11:6 And in the end of years they shall join themselves together; for the king's daughter of the south shall come to the king of the north to make an agreement: but she shall not retain the power of the arm; neither shall he stand, nor his arm: but she shall be given up, and they that brought her, and he that Begat her, and he that strengthened her in these times.

DESIGNED FOR

Establishing friendship.

1 Samuel 18:3 Then Jonathan and David made a covenant, because he loved him as his own soul.

Procuring assistance in war.

1 Kings 15:18-19 Then Asa took all the silver and the gold that were left in the treasures of the house of the LORD, and the treasures of the king's house, and delivered them into the hand of his servants: and king Asa sent them to Benhadad, the son of Tabrimon, the son of Hezion, king of Syria, that dwelt at Damascus, saying, 19 There is a league between me and thee, and between my Father and thy Father: behold, I have sent unto thee a present of silver and gold; come and break thy league with Baasha king of Israel, that he may depart from me.

Mutual protection.

Genesis 26:28 And they said, We saw certainly that the LORD was with thee: and we said, Let there be now an Oath Betwixt us, even Betwixt us and thee, and let us make a covenant with thee;

Genesis 31:50-52 If thou shalt afflict my daughters, or if thou shalt take other wives beside my daughters, no man is with us; see, God is Witness Betwixt me and thee. 51 And Laban said to Jacob, Behold this heap, and behold this pillar, which I have cast Betwixt me and thee; 52 This heap be Witness, and this pillar be Witness, that I will not pass over this heap to thee, and that thou shalt not pass over this heap and this pillar unto me, for harm.

Establishing peace.

Joshua 9:15-16 And Joshua made peace with them, and made a league with them, to let them live: and the Princes of the Congregation sware unto them. 16 And it came to pass at the end of three days after they had made a league with them, that they heard that they were their neighbours, and that they dwelt among them.

Promoting commerce.

1 Kings 5:6-11 Now therefore command thou that they hew me cedar trees out of Lebanon; and my servants shall be with thy servants: and unto thee will I give hire for thy servants according to all that thou shalt appoint: for thou knowest that there is not among us any that can skill to hew timber like unto the Sidonians. 7 And it came to pass, when Hiram heard the words of Solomon, that he rejoiced greatly, and said, Blessed be the LORD this day, which hath given unto David a wise son over this great people. 8 And Hiram sent to Solomon, saying, I have considered the things which thou sentest to me for: and I will do all thy desire concerning timber of cedar, and concerning timber of fir. 9 My servants shall bring them down from Lebanon unto the sea: and I will convey them by sea in floats unto the place that thou shalt appoint me, and will cause them to be discharged there, and thou shalt receive them: and thou shalt accomplish my desire, in giving food for my household. ...

Selling land.

Genesis 23:14-16 And Ephron answered Abraham, saying unto him, 15 My lord, hearken unto me: the land is worth four hundred shekels of silver; what is that Betwixt me and thee? bury therefore thy Dead. 16 And Abraham hearkened unto Ephron; and Abraham weighed to Ephron the silver, which he had named in the audience of the sons of Heth, four hundred shekels of silver, current money with the merchant.

CONDITIONS OF,

Clearly specified.

1 Samuel 11:1-2 Then Nahash the Ammonite came up, and encamped against Jabeshgilead: and all the men of Jabesh said unto Nahash, Make a covenant with us, and we will serve thee. 2 And Nahash the Ammonite answered them, On this condition will I make a covenant with you, that I may thrust out all your right eyes, and lay it for a reproach upon all Israel.

Conformed by Oath.

Genesis 21:23 Now therefore swear unto me here by God that thou wilt not deal falsely with me, nor with my son, nor with my son's son: but according to the kindness that I have done unto thee, thou shalt do unto me, and to the land wherein thou hast sojourned.

Genesis 26:31 And they rose up Betimes in the morning, and sware one to another: and Isaac sent them away, and they departed from him in peace.

Witnessed.

Genesis 23:17-18 And the field of Ephron, which was in Machpelah, which was before Mamre, the field, and the Cave which was therein, and all the trees that were in the field, that were in all the

borders round about, were made sure 18 Unto Abraham for a possession in the presence of the children of Heth, before all that went in at the gate of his city. Written and sealed.

Nehemiah 9:38-10:1 And because of all this we make a sure covenant, and write it; and our Princes, Levites, and priests, seal unto it. 1 Now those that sealed were, Nehemiah, the Tirshatha, the son of Hachaliah, and Zidkijah, God often called to Witness.

Genesis 31:50 If thou shalt afflict my daughters, or if thou shalt take other wives beside my daughters, no man is with us; see, God is Witness Betwixt me and thee.

Genesis 31:53 The God of Abraham, and the God of Nahor, the God of their Father, Judge Betwixt us. And Jacob swore by the fear of his Father Isaac. When confirmed, unalterable.

Galatians 3:15 Brethren, I speak after the manner of men; Though it be but a man's covenant, yet if it be confirmed, no man disannulleth, or addeth thereto.

Made by passing between the pieces of the divided sacrifices.

Genesis 15:9-17 And he said unto him, Take me an heifer of three years old, and a she goat of three years old, and a ram of three years old, and a turtledove, and a young pigeon. 10 And he took unto him all these, and divided them in the midst, and laid each piece one against another: but the birds divided he not. 11 And when the fowls came down upon the carcases, Abram Drove them away. 12 And when the sun was going down, a deep sleep fell upon Abram; and, lo, an horror of great darkness fell upon him. .

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Jeremiah 34:18-19 And I will give the men that have transgressed my covenant, which have not performed the words of the covenant which they had made before me, when they cut the calf in twain, and passed between the parts thereof, 19 The Princes of Judah, and the Princes of Jerusalem, the eunuchs, and the priests, and all the people of the land, which passed between the parts of the calf; Salt a sign of perpetuity in.

Numbers 18:19 All the heave offerings of the holy things, which the children of Israel offer unto the LORD, have I given thee, and thy sons and thy daughters with thee, by a statute for ever: it is a covenant of salt for ever before the LORD unto thee and to thy seed with thee.

2 Chronicles 13:5 Ought ye not to know that the LORD God of Israel gave the kingdom over Israel to David for ever, even to him and to his sons by a covenant of salt?

Ratified by joining hands.

Proverbs 11:21 Though hand join in hand, the wicked shall not be unpunished: but the seed of the Righteous shall be delivered.

Ezekiel 17:18 Seeing he despised the Oath by breaking the covenant, when, lo, he had given his hand, and hath done all these things, he shall not escape. Followed by a feast.

Genesis 26:30 And he made them a feast, and they did eat and drink.

Genesis 31:54 Then Jacob offered sacrifice upon the mount, and called his Brethren to eat bread: and they did eat bread, and tarried all night in the mount.

Presents given as tokens of.

Genesis 21:27-30 And Abraham took sheep and oxen, and gave them unto Abimelech; and both of them made a covenant. 28 And Abraham set seven ewe lambs of the flock by themselves. 29 And Abimelech said unto Abraham, What mean these seven ewe lambs which thou hast set by themselves? 30 And he said, For these seven ewe lambs shalt thou take of my hand, that they may be a Witness unto me, that I have digged this

well.

1 Samuel 18:3-4 Then Jonathan and David made a covenant, because he loved him as his own soul. 4 And Jonathan stripped himself of the robe that was upon him, and gave it to David, and his garments, even to his sword, and to his bow, and to his girdle.

Pillars raised in token of.

Genesis 31:45-46 And Jacob took a stone, and set it up for a pillar. 46 And Jacob said unto his Brethren, Gather stones; and they took stones, and made an heap: and they did eat there upon the heap.

Names given to places where made.

Genesis 21:31 Wherefore he called that place Beersheba; because there they swore both of them.

Genesis 31:47-49 And Laban called it Jegarsahadutha: but Jacob called it Galeed. 48 And Laban said, This heap is a Witness between me and thee this day. Therefore was the name of it called Galeed; 49 And Mizpah; for he said, The LORD watch between me and thee, when we are absent one from another.

THE JEWS

Forbidden to make, with the nations of Canaan.

Exodus 23:32 Thou shalt make no covenant with them, nor with their gods.

Deuteronomy 7:2 And when the LORD thy God shall deliver them before thee; thou shalt smite them, and utterly destroy them; thou shalt make no covenant with them, nor shew mercy unto them:

Frequently made with other nations.

1 Kings 5:12 And the LORD gave Solomon wisdom, as he promised him: and there was peace between Hiram and Solomon; and they two made a league together.

2 Kings 17:4 And the king of Assyria found conspiracy in Hoshea: for he had sent messengers to So king of Egypt, and brought no present to the king of Assyria, as he had done year by year: therefore the king of Assyria shut him up, and bound him in prison.

Condemned for making, with idolatrous nations.

Isaiah 30:2-5 That walk to go down into Egypt, and have not asked at my mouth; to strengthen themselves in the strength of Pharaoh, and to trust in the shadow of Egypt!

3 Therefore shall the strength of Pharaoh be your shame, and the trust in the shadow of Egypt your confusion. 4 For his Princes were at Zoan, and his ambassadors came to Hanes. 5 They were all ashamed of a people that could not profit them, nor be an help nor profit, but a shame, and also a reproach.

Hosea 12:1 Ephraim feedeth on wind, and followeth after the east wind: he daily increaseth lies and desolation; and they do make a covenant with the Assyrians, and oil is carried into Egypt.

Regarded, as sacred.

Joshua 9:16-19 And it came to pass at the end of three days after they had made a league with them, that they heard that they were their neighbours, and that they dwelt among them. 17 And the children of Israel journeyed, and came unto their cities on the third day. Now their cities were Gibeon, and Chephirah, and Beeroth, and Kirjathjearim.

18 And the children of Israel smote them not, because the Princes of the Congregation had sworn unto them by the LORD God of Israel. And all the Congregation murmured against the Princes. 19 But all the Princes said unto all the Congregation, We have sworn unto them by the LORD God of Israel: now therefore we may not touch them.

Psalms 15:4 In whose eyes a vile person is contemned; but he honoureth them that fear the LORD. He that sweareth to his own hurt, and changeth not.

Violated by the wicked.

Romans 1:31 Without understanding, covenantbreakers, without natural affection, implacable, unmerciful:

2 Timothy 3:3 Without natural affection, trucebreakers, false accusers, incontinent, fierce, despisers of those that are good,

ILLUSTRATIVE

Of the contract of marriage.

Malachi 2:14 Yet ye say, Wherefore? Because the LORD hath been Witness between thee and the wife of thy youth, against whom thou hast dealt treacherously: yet is she thy companion, and the wife of thy covenant.

Of God's promises to man.

Genesis 9:9-11 And I, behold, I establish my covenant with you, and with your seed after you; 10 And with every living creature that is with you, of the fowl, of the cattle, and of every beast of the earth with you; from all that go out of the ark, to every beast of the earth. 11 And I will establish my covenant with you; neither shall all flesh be cut off any more by the waters of a flood; neither shall there any more be a flood to destroy the earth.

Ephesians 2:12 That at that time ye were without Christ, being aliens from the commonwealth of Israel, and strangers from the covenants of promise, having no hope, and without God in the world:

Of the united determination of a people to serve God.

2 Kings 11:17 And Jehoiada made a covenant between the LORD and the king and the people, that they should be the LORDS' people; between the king also and the people.

2 Chronicles 15:12 And they entered into a covenant to seek the LORD God of their Fathers with all their heart and with all their soul;

Nehemiah 10:29 They clave to their Brethren, their nobles, and entered into a curse, and into an Oath, to walk in God's law, which was given by Moses the Servant of God, and to observe and do all the commandments of the LORD our Lord, and his judgments and his statutes;

Of good resolutions.

Job 31:1 I made a covenant with mine eyes; why then should I think upon a maid?

(With Death and Hell,) of Carnal security.

Isaiah 28:15 Because ye have said, We have made a covenant with Death, and with Hell are we at agreement; when the overflowing scourge shall pass through, it shall not come unto us: for we have made lies our refuge, and under falsehood have we hid ourselves:

Isaiah 28:18 And your covenant with Death shall be disannulled, and your agreement with Hell shall not stand; when the overflowing scourge shall pass through, then ye shall be trodden down by it.

(With stones and beasts of the earth,) of peace and prosperity.

Job 5:23 For thou shalt be in league with the stones of the field: and the beasts of the field shall be at peace with thee.

Hosea 2:18 And in that day will I make a covenant for them with the beasts of the field, and with the fowls of heaven, and with the creeping things of the ground: and I will break the bow and the sword and the battle out of the earth, and will make them to lie down safely.